

Business Case

Business & Strategy Analytics



Assignment

As part of our interview process, we present to you the following business case. We ask you to prepare a presentation of 25 minutes in which we will go through various aspects of the work as a Business and Strategy Analyst.

You could easily spend a full time week to perfect this case and get all insights out of it, but we urge you to also prioritize and not spend too much time on it.

We expect you to do research using the data you've been provided, your business acumen, what you can find on our platform, and potentially also use external research. You will present the outcomes of this case to both fellow analysts and business partners.

Good luck!

Marktplaats and 2dehands serve 100k SMB sellers

Adevinta BNL consists of Marktplaats and 2dehands/2ememain, the largest Classifieds platforms in the Dutch and Belgian markets. On our platforms we facilitate trade for millions of users on a daily base. Our businesses are embedded in our societies, being used by people who want to sell their used items, start a business, look for something special or something nearby, or who are simply looking for a good deal. On average, we have about 400,000 new listings per day.

We currently serve our small-medium business (SMB) sellers through different propositions:

- Pro: our pay-per-click proposition, we offer sellers the opportunity to only pay a certain amount (CPC, usually 1-4 cents) when their ads have been clicked by a user. They set their CPC to bid against other sellers for more visibility. This is often, but certainly not exclusively, used by sellers who have their own web shop. They list through the Pro console, and this stream is an important revenue driver for us.
- SYI, short for Sell-Your-Item, users use our regular ad listing flow on our app or web site, through which they list their products. The SYI is used by both business sellers and consumers. In some categories sellers must pay us a fee to list their ads, which we call insertion fees. Also, they can choose to give their ads more visibility through features, for which they pay a feature fee.

With these propositions, almost 100,000 SMB sellers actively use our platforms to sell their items. The two propositions, however, are not aligned and not jointly offered to the sellers.

The data from these two propositions also sits in separate places in our data warehouse, and is rarely combined. A seller might switch from Pro to SYI, and the Pro team falsely thinks the seller has fully churned.



Question 1: How can we identify SMB sellers

In our businesses we have always seen it as a strength that registration is very low effort. You only need an email address and a phone number to start trading on our platforms.

The downside of this is that we do not have a full customer view of our users. Especially in our SYI flow, we do not know much about our sellers. We do, however, know a lot about what happens on our platforms. We can easily understand the behavior of our visitors; buyers, sellers, and browsers.

In the first attachment, a list of information can be found that we do have on our sellers and the activity. This data goes three years back.

It is December 2024. We want to introduce SMB bundles, which will make it easier for SMB sellers to use our platform to reach our enormous customer base. To launch this, a big task is to identify which sellers are actual business sellers and which are consumers. We cannot simply call all 10+ million users to ask this, and using a pop-up on our platform is not expected to bring reliable results. We need to narrow down this base as good as we can using the existing data.

Using the description of the available data, think of identifiers that point towards a seller being SMB, and argue why you believe these could be good indicators. Combine information from the various sources to think of 3-8 good identifiers. (For example, "Every seller that has listed at least 2 advertisements in the category 'Tuin en Terras' (Garden and terrace) is likely to be a business seller".)



Question 2: Who should we prioritize in our outreach?

Using the selection criteria you made, we have manually picked about 100 sellers at random to check if they were indeed businesses, and for the ones we were unsure of, we gave them a call. It turns out that 83% were business sellers, good job!

It is now March 2025, and the product development for the SMB bundles has completed. We are ready to launch them. The bundles come in two flavors:

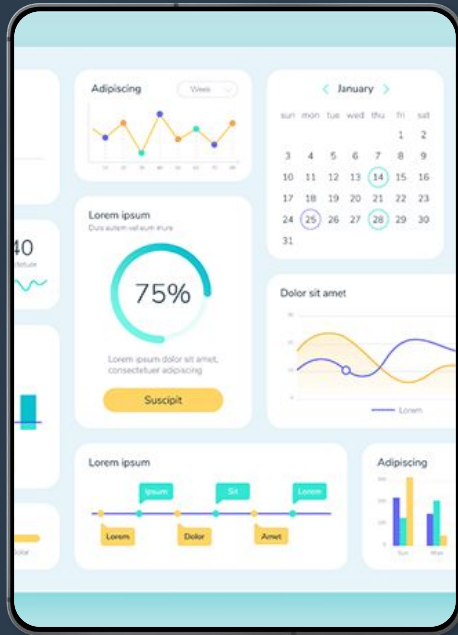
- Basic: You will both get you a “Verified seller” icon, a professional seller page, extra pictures for more visibility.
- Plus: You will get all advantages of Basic, plus extra visibility stickers, and on every ad you get a photo gallery with a link to your other ads.

We have attached a 5% sample of identified prospects. The data consists of monthly usage statistics per category per seller, showing the ads and the features they have used, of the period 2023-2024. In total there are approximately 80k of these prospects in Marktplaats. In our first batch we want to reach out to the 20k sellers that we believe have most potential at this point in time.

To make sure we prioritize the right sellers, we ask you to analyze the data set. We want to call the highest potentials. Provide explorative analyses, and give a recommendation on what type of users to call, and clearly answering why. Any differentiation between which sellers we offer which bundle?

P.S. For this case we only included the SYI sellers, not the Pro sellers, and we excluded cars and jobs ads.

Question 3: How do we monitor the sales?



Flashforward to after the launch of the SMB Bundles.

Thanks to your outreach prioritization we have done several subsequent batches of calls, and bundle registrations have been coming in. In the third dataset you can find an overview of SMB sellers from both SYI and Pro, showing which bundle they purchased, with a start and end date.

As a promotion, the first 28 days are for free. After that they pay:

- €19.99 per 4 weeks for a Basic bundle
- €49.99 per 4 weeks for a Plus bundle

Every seller can only get a discount once. They can stop their bundle, or switch to another one at any point in the month. For this business case, assume they immediately pay for the full 4 weeks (unless it's their first bundle ever and thus get a discount), and do not get a refund for any time left in their previous bundle.

Design and present a dashboard that will help you show the impact of our Bundle introduction, and any other important analysis or metrics. The dashboard should both be useful at the launch and at the later stages. Use the data that is available to already fill parts of your dashboard design, while clearly stating what other data you would need to complete your view.



Question 4: Marketing Campaign Proposal

The introduction of SMB Bundles has provided value to both Marktplaats and our SMB sellers, as they are now more visible on our platform and are able to distinguish themselves from others.

Without access to additional data, we would like you to think conceptually and answer the following:

Imagine you are tasked with promoting the new SMB bundles more broadly. Propose one marketing campaign, including the target audience, the channel(s) you would use, and the key KPI(s) you would focus on to measure success.